

The Noble Great Sūtra on Entering the City of Vaiśālī

Ārya Vaiśālī Praveśa Mahāsūtra · Toh 628 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཡངས་པའི་གོ་ཁུངས་ལ་མཇུག་པའི་ཆོ་རྒྱུ་པོ་

The Noble Great Sūtra on Entering the City of Vaiśālī, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Vaiśālī Praveśa Mahāsūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa yangs pa'i grong khyer du 'jug pa'i mdo chen po, is a Mahāyāna sūtra that recounts events surrounding the Buddha's journey to the renowned city of Vaiśālī in the land of Vṛji. The text opens with the Buddha instructing his attendant Ānanda to travel with him to Vaiśālī, where he takes up residence in the Mango Grove of Ambapālī, a setting familiar from other canonical accounts associated with this city. As a sūtra framed in the classical "thus did I hear" narrative style, it belongs to the discourse literature of the Buddhist canon. It is catalogued as Toh 628 in the Kangyur, where it is counted among the general sūtra collections.

— as for outshining its brilliance, that goes without saying; to even look upon it is impossible. This concludes that section.

In the language of India: Ārya Vaiśālī Praveśa Mahāsūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Sūtra on Entering the City of Vaiśālī.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in a resting place amid a thicket of reeds. Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us proceed to that place — to the city of Vaiśālī." "Venerable One, so be it," he replied, and the Venerable Ānanda listened and obeyed the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One set out, traveling through the land of Vṛji, and arrived at the city of Vaiśālī, where he took up residence in the Mango Grove of Ambapālī.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go to the city of Vaiśālī. When you have arrived, place your foot on the threshold of the gate and recite these mantra foundations and these verses:

Bisarata, bisarata, bisarata, bisarata. Thus has the Buddha, who is compassionate toward the world, declared.

mi ti, si sī, si mī, kaṃ ka ra, ka ra ka ta, kaṃ ka ra, kaṃ ka ca, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā.

kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka rā, kaṃ ka ro tī ti, ku ri śaṃ kaṃ ka ra, kaṃ ka ri śe, ri ri ri ri ri ri, ti re te phu svā, ri pu ri pu, ri pu ri pu, ri pu ri pu, ri pu, nā thā nā nā thā tha, ri pu, ri pu, nā thā tha, nir gaccha ta, ri pu, ri pu, nir gaccha ta, pa yā tha, ri pū, ri pū, pa lā ya ta.

The buddhas, who cherish the world with loving tenderness, who are endowed with special intention directed toward the benefit of all sentient beings, who abide in loving-kindness, who are endowed with compassion, who abide in joy, who abide in equanimity — may they come, and may this ground depart: kṣi phra ni r gaccha ta svāhā.

By the supreme gnosis of the buddhas, and by the sacred mantra proclaimed through the nature of reality to all gods and to all spirits, these grounds, these very grounds, are consecrated. These verses, too, are accomplished.

He in whom miserliness has been completely dispelled,
who, having vanquished it, has rendered it without blemish,
whose mind is peaceful and who harbors no harm —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

The guide who leads all beings
onto the path of liberation,
and who teaches all phenomena —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

The Teacher, support of the swift-moving ones,
who for the sake of all sentient beings
has obtained bliss —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

The protector who, with a mind of loving-kindness,
constantly tends all these beings of every kind
as though they were his only child —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

He who, for all sentient beings
wandering in cyclic existence,
has become their support, their isle, and their ally —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

He for whom all phenomena are manifest and directly known,
who is pure and utterly without deception,
and who renders his speech immaculately pure —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

The great hero who has arisen,
who is fully accomplished in excellent purpose and endowment,
by whom both aim and accumulation are fulfilled —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

He at whose birth the very earth,
together with its forests, shook and trembled greatly,
and all sentient beings were filled with delight —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

When he went to the heart of awakening,
the sixfold earth quaked in all its parts,
and the mind of Māra was made ill at ease —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

When he turned the wheel of Dharma
and proclaimed the noble truths in full,
he from whom arose the thought of the Sage —
may he bring you wellbeing and good fortune.

He who, by his captivating power, defeats all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
who overcomes them all through Dharma,
and who brings the entire assembly under his sway —
may he bestow upon you wellbeing and good fortune.

May the buddhas bestow wellbeing and good fortune upon you;
may Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) together with all the gods bestow
wellbeing and good fortune;
and may the wellbeing and good fortune of all spirits
be ever given to you.

By the power and merit of the buddhas,
and by the aspiration of the gods,
whatever aim you desire —
may that aim be accomplished this very day.

May you who walk on two feet have wellbeing and good fortune.
May you who walk on four feet have wellbeing and good fortune.

May all of you who travel the road have wellbeing and good fortune.
May those who come and go likewise have wellbeing and good fortune.
Wellbeing and good fortune by day, wellbeing and good fortune by night,
wellbeing and good fortune at the midday sun as well —
may all of you always have wellbeing and good fortune,
and may none of you come to harm.

May the buddhas and the thousand gods,
surrounding and escorting you as they go,
deal with those who hold malicious minds,
while those of compassionate nature form your retinue.

By the words of truth of the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas,
the arhats, and the learners,
may those who do harm to the world
be expelled from this city.

May all sentient beings and all living creatures,
all spirits and all of you,
be possessed of happiness alone;
may all be free from illness.
May all behold what is good.

May none of them commit any evil.
May the spirits that have gathered here,
those dwelling on the earth and in the sky,
always practice loving-kindness toward all living beings,
and may they practice the Dharma by day and by night.

Having thus declared this, the Venerable Ānanda said to the elder, "It shall be done as the Blessed One has commanded," and, having heard accordingly from the Blessed One, he set out for the city of Vaiśālī. Then, standing at the threshold of the gate, he also recited these dhāraṇī foundations and these verses:

Bisarata. Bisarata. Bisarata. Bisarata.

This was declared by the buddha who is compassionate toward the world.

All buddhas have so intended it. All pratyekabuddhas have so thought it. All arhats have so thought it. All learners have so thought it. All śrāvakas have so thought it. All who are possessed of words of truth have so thought it. The

Dharma has so thought it. Brahmā has so thought it. Each Brahmā individually has so thought it. The lord of desire has so thought it. Indra has so thought it. The gods have so thought it. The lord of the asuras has so thought it. All the asuras have so thought it. The messengers of the asuras have so thought it. All spirits have so thought it.

Bisarata. Bisarata. Bisarata. Bisarata.

This was declared by the buddha who is compassionate toward the world.

Muñcata. Muñcata. Muñcata. Muñcata.

Let them not remain. May all epidemic diseases be pacified.

Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata.

The buddha is the great deity among gods, the deity above deities, the teacher of gods. He has come. With him come the gods together with Indra, those together with Brahmā, those together with the lord of sovereigns, those together with the lord of living beings, and the four guardians of the world. Many thousands of gods come, and the lords of the asuras come, and many thousands of asuras come. Many hundreds and thousands of spirits who have faith in the Blessed One come as well, for the sake of all sentient beings. They will do great harm to those who harm you.

Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata. Nirgacchata. Depart swiftly!

May those among you who bear minds of aversion be destroyed. May those who bear minds of loving-kindness and who wish no ill and desire to offer protection take their place. Enter also into their bodies.

This was declared by the buddha who is compassionate toward the world:

Sumu. Sumu. Sumu. Sumu. Sumu. Sumuru. Sumuru. Sumuru. Sumuru. Sumuru. Sumuru. Sumuru. Muru. Muru. Muru. Muru. Muru. Muru. Muru. Miri. Miri. Miri. Miri. Miri. Miri. Miri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murumiri. Murūriti. Ririri ri. Riri. Rī rī rī rī. Rīrīti. Mirimiri. Mirimiri. Mirimiri. Mirimirīti. Hasimimirīti. Sīsima. Kaṃkarā. Karakata. Karakarakara. Kaca. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarotīti kuriso kaṃkarā. Kaṃkarīśe. Riri riri. Riri rī. Taratepusvā. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Ripu. Nāthā. Nānāthāthā. Ripuripu. Nathāthā. Nirgacchata. Ripuripu. Nirgacchata. Palayātra. Ripuripu. Palayātra.

The buddha who is compassionate toward the world, who is supremely attentive to the benefit of all sentient beings, who abides in loving-kindness, who is endowed with compassion, who abides in joy, who abides in equanimity —

Gakṣi phraṃ nirgacchata svāhā.

These foundations of secret mantra, spoken through the supreme wisdom of the buddhas and through the very nature of reality to all the gods and all spirits, are hereby fulfilled. These verses, too, are fulfilled.

He who has conquered all stinginess and desire, who makes all defilement spotless, whose mind is at peace and who holds no harm — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

The guide who leads all beings onto the path of liberation, who teaches all phenomena — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

The Teacher, the support of those who run to him, who for the sake of all sentient beings dwells in happiness — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

The protector whose mind of loving-kindness perpetually tends to all these beings as though they were his only child — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

He who, for all sentient beings wandering in saṃsāra, has become their support, their island, and their ally — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

He for whom all phenomena are directly manifest, who is pure and free of all deception, who makes his speech utterly pure — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

The great hero whose birth brought excellence and abundance into reach, through whom purpose is achieved and accumulation fulfilled — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

He at whose birth the realms of the earth, along with their forests, trembled mightily, and all sentient beings rejoiced — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

He at the seat of awakening through whose power the six pure lands were shaken, and by whom Māra's mind was made uneasy — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

When he turned the wheel of Dharma, proclaiming the noble truths in full, the fame of the Sage arose and spread — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

He who, with his magnificent presence, defeated all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) through the Dharma, and brought every assembly under his sway — may he bring you well-being and happiness.

May the buddhas grant you well-being and happiness. May Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) and all the gods bring you well-being and happiness. May the well-being of all spirits be given to you always.

By the power of the merit of the buddhas, and by the intention of the gods, may whatever purpose and wish you hold be accomplished this very day.

May you who walk on two feet be well and happy. May you who walk on four feet be well and happy. May you travel the road in well-being and happiness. May those who return also be well and happy.

May there be well-being by day and well-being by night. May there be well-being at the midday sun as well. May all of you be well and happy everywhere. May none of you fall into wrongdoing.

May the buddhas and the thousand gods, having surrounded and proceeded hence, drive away all those who bear hostile minds, and may those of compassionate nature remain.

By the words of truth of the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas, the arhats, and those in training — may all those who are harmful to the world be expelled from this city.

May all sentient beings and all living creatures, all spirits and all of you, possess happiness and nothing but happiness. May all be free of sickness. May all see what is good. May none whatsoever fall into wrongdoing.

Whatever spirits have gathered here, dwelling on the earth and in the sky — may they always show loving-kindness to all living beings, and may they also practice the Dharma day and night.

Here ends the noble sūtra entitled Entering the Great City of Vaiśālī.

This was translated by the paṇḍita Surendra Bodhi and the great reviser and translator Bandé —

Translator's Notes

- The opening fragment — "as for outshining its brilliance, that goes without saying; to even look upon it is impossible" — is the tail end of a preceding passage, presumably describing a brilliant light or luminous form so radiant that other beings cannot even look at it, let alone outshine it. Without the preceding context, the referent cannot be confirmed, but the rendering follows the grammar directly.

The phrase rendered "the great god among gods, the god above gods, the teacher of gods" is an elevated epithet applied to the Buddha, listing him as superior even to the greatest of devas. This is a standard Buddhist rhetorical move subordinating all divine beings to the Buddha's supremacy.

The section containing "Awaken! Awaken!" renders the Tibetan "sangs rgyas shig," which literally uses the verbal imperative of the word for buddha — "awaken!" or "be awake!" — directed at the protective spirits being called upon. This is a deliberate doctrinal and rhetorical flourish: the word buddha here functions as an imperative verb in its etymological sense.

The mantra syllables throughout this passage are transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables. They are preserved as-is, as is standard practice for such sacred formula passages in canonical translation.

- The passage opens with a continuation of dhāraṇī syllables, including the phrase "nir gaccha ta" (Sanskrit: nirgacchata, "depart!") and "pa lā ya ta" (Sanskrit: palāyata, "flee!"), which are commands directed at malevolent spirits. These are standard dhāraṇī formulae and are transliterated rather than translated, consistent with the preceding passage.

The phrase rendered "support of the swift-moving ones" translates a line describing the Teacher as a support or refuge for those who are spiritually active or energetically progressing on the path. The exact referent of "swift-moving ones" is contextually understood as practitioners or beings who strive earnestly.

The verse "kṣi phra ni r gaccha ta svāhā" is a hybrid dhāraṇī formula embedded within the prose section and is preserved in transliteration as is standard for mantra material.

- The mantra syllables throughout this passage are transliterated from Sanskrit dhāraṇī material preserved in Tibetan phonetic transcription. The forms Bisarata, Muñcata, Nirgacchata, and Palayātra correspond to recognizable Sanskrit imperatives or verbal forms common in apotropaic dhāraṇī literature. The long mantra sequence from Sumu onward is largely phonetic and does not yield consistent semantic parsing; it is rendered as transliteration rather than translation, which is standard practice for such material. The passage ends mid-sentence, indicating it continues beyond the supplied text.

- The colophon breaks off mid-sentence, ending with the title of the Tibetan translator (Bandé), whose full name is not given in the surviving passage. This is a standard colophon truncation and not a translation uncertainty.

The opening mantra syllables "Gakṣi phraṇ nirgacchata svāhā" are transliterated Indic dhāraṇī material embedded in the Tibetan text; they are not semantically rendered but carried over as liturgical formulae, consistent with the treatment of the preceding mantra passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those

texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.